Plan 2: A Saturday out in London

Start: London Bridge station at 10:00 · 4 stops, including lunch
Costs: about £15 for food and entry, plus about £3 transport

1. 10:11–11:01 St Dunstan-in-the-East: a ruined church garden hidden in the City

Getting there: about 11 min on foot from London Bridge station.
Walk down St Dunstan's Hill towards the river.
Among office blocks, you walk into the ruins of a medieval church that is now a public garden.
Cost: free

2. 11:12–12:02 The Garden at 120: a rooftop garden among the City towers

Getting there: about 6 min on foot from St Dunstan-in-the-East.
Go into Hogarth Court from Fenchurch Street or Fenchurch Avenue, pass an airport-style security check, and take the lift to floor 15.
You step out 15 floors up into a garden of wisteria, roses and hydrangeas around a water feature, with the City's towers all around and views to the Thames and Tower Bridge.
Cost: free

3. 12:53–13:38 Lunch near Cutty Sark DLR station

Getting there: about 41 min: walk to Bank, Monument or Fenchurch Street station, then take the Tube or bus to Cutty Sark DLR station.
Pick a café, pub or food stall nearby.
Food: about £15

4. 13:43–15:00 The whole of London from General Wolfe's hill, Greenwich Park

Walk into the park and up the steep hill to the statue beside the Royal Observatory: about 15-20 min, the last part uphill.
At the top, all of London opens up across the river: Canary Wharf, the Shard and St Paul's.
Best: Late afternoon on a clear day
Cost: free
If it rains: The Uber Boat up the river from Greenwich to Battersea, by day, about 10 min away on foot.